

Making innovation practical

TIP

KEEP AN OPEN MIND

Consider all ideas, no matter how strange, in their initial stages. Something that appears totally impractical at first may lead to useful thinking about other, more workable solutions.

There's still plenty of room for ideas to improve the world we live in—and we are still really good at coming up with them. But innovation isn't just about bright ideas; it's also about putting those ideas into practice. No matter how good the idea, it will not benefit your organization if it cannot be transformed into a practical change in the work process that increases efficiency or profit. A working definition of innovation would be: innovation = ideas + implementation.

Understanding the issues

Thinking about managing innovation raises three key issues. First, why should we innovate? Innovation always involves risks, and the rewards are not always obvious. Second, what can we change? You need to understand the options for innovation before you can make decisions on where to focus your efforts. And finally, how can we make it happen?

The innovation process



IDEAS

The starting point for innovation is an idea for improving an aspect of your operations.



IMPLEMENTATION

Your idea must become a practical reality before it can benefit your organization.



INNOVATION

Successful innovation takes place only when both of these elements are achieved.